

VARSHA SATHYANARAYANAN

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PROFILE

Data-driven merchandiser with relevant experience in buying, category management, and P&L ownership across omnichannel retail. Proven track record of scaling categories from near zero to 25+ subcategories, improving margins from 22% to 35%, and driving sell-through through assortment optimization and vendor negotiation. Skilled in OTB planning, advanced Excel, and cross-functional collaboration to deliver profitable growth in fast-paced value retail environments.

COMPETENCIES

Core Competencies	Tools	Functional Strengths
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EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India
Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ coco stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L management, and data-led merchandising decisions.

- Built fashion category from 5 to 25+ subcategories across menswear, womenswear, kidswear, footwear, and accessories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking against value retailers like DMart and Vishal Mega Mart.
- Drove ₹3.5 lakh in category revenue within two months by analyzing weekly sales, pricing benchmarks, and customer demand signals to optimize sell-through.
- Improved product margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation on pricing, MOQs, and sourcing terms while maintaining competitive retail pricing.
- Partnered with marketing to launch fashion-led campaigns during New Year, Pongal, and Republic Day, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign period sales.
- Reduced stock-outs by ~20% across priority products by collaborating with operations and supply chain to improve stock availability and coordinate warehouse invoicing and inventory flow.
- Tracked sell-through, AOV, and margin performance using Excel and Metabase dashboards; identified underperforming SKUs and implemented assortment rationalization that improved category gross margin by ~6%.

Founder

The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India

Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.

- Generated ₹50,000 in revenue during the launch phase with an average order value of ₹600, fulfilling 80+ customer orders across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities with zero product returns.
- Sourced and merchandised 60+ SKUs across tops, skirts, and dresses through direct supplier negotiations, maintaining 45% gross margins and reducing sourcing turnaround time by 25%.
- Evaluated and engaged 5 supplier partners before finalizing a primary vendor to optimize pricing, quality consistency, and procurement turnaround time.
- Executed pricing, merchandising, and inventory tracking through Excel-based systems, ensuring 100% order fulfillment and streamlined stock management.
- Managed 60+ SKUs on Swiggy Minis and built a custom Excel-based WIP tracker to manage catalog listings, order tracking, and inventory visibility, reducing catalog errors by 90% and improving stock flow for fast-selling styles.
- Produced 25+ branded content assets and launched 3+ Instagram ad campaigns, improving click-through rates by 22% through A/B testing and targeted messaging.

Assistant Fashion Manager

Go Colors (Go Fashion India Ltd.), Chennai, India

Sept 2020 - June 2023

Supported buying and merchandising for women's and girls' bottom-wear categories including leggings, track pants, formal pants, ethnic bottoms, and shorts, with responsibility for vendor coordination, product lifecycle execution, and data-led assortment decisions.

- Managed PO/PI coordination and vendor communication across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders.
- Improved category sell-through by 15% by analyzing weekly sales performance for 200+ SKUs and recommending replenishment and assortment adjustments.
- Drove a 10% lift in customer purchase rate across key bottom-wear categories by aligning assortment planning with trend insights and performance data.
- Launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, leading a 2-member team to introduce new styles and revamp existing collections, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
- Negotiated supplier pricing and MOQs during fabric sourcing and production planning, maintaining product quality while ensuring competitive margins.
- Led sampling, fit approvals, and production coordination for 30+ styles per season, reducing post-launch return rates to under 10% while gaining exposure to PLM-driven product development workflows.
- Built WIP trackers to monitor production timelines and collaborated with logistics, VM, and marketing teams to ensure timely product launches.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business

Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management

Toronto, Canada | Sept 2023, Aug 2024

National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT)

Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design

Chennai, India | July 2016, July 2020

SKILLS

Core Competencies	Assortment Planning · Fashion Buying · PO/PI Coordination · Vendor Management · Inventory · Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order Tracking
Tools	Advanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)
Functional Strengths	Cross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation